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COMMUNITY CORNER PARSHAS ACHAREI MOS-KEDOSHIM אחרי מות קדשים



SHABBOS STARTS: **7:28 PM**
(18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS: **8:37 PM**
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: **8:58 PM**
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



Napoleon personally commanded his mighty army in order to realize his dream of capturing India and other lands in the Far East. He captured Egypt and from there marched into the Land of Israel. About the same time, in the year 1798, a great-grandson of the Baal Shem Tov, Rabbi Nachman, arrived in Israel. His hope was to quench his thirst for Torah from the great saintly Sages living in the ancient city of Safed.

Once, after concluding his prayers with great concentration and devotion, he lay down on the grass to rest and fell asleep. Suddenly, in his dream, he beheld an old man who told him to go to Tiberias where he had an important mission to carry out on the banks of Lake Kinneret.

Reb Nachman wasted not a moment. He gathered his things and hurried off toward Tiberias. There, he rented a room in the house of a fisherman. Napoleon, in the meantime, had made his headquarters on the east bank of Lake Kinneret. He was receiving reports that there was much unrest in France, and that his opponents were seeking an opportunity to dethrone him. In this unsettling atmosphere, it was not easy for Napoleon to maintain the strict military discipline upon which the success of his armies depended.

One day, a thieving band of soldiers set out on a rampage, raiding the homes of the poor fishermen near Lake Kinneret. Three soldiers dashed into the home where Reb Nachman lived and demanded from the old Jewish fisherman all his money. "I am too old to go fishing anymore and my only son supports me," explained the elderly man. "I have no money."

The disappointed soldiers began beating the old Jew mercilessly. Reb Nachman heard the commotion from his attic room and hurried to the rescue.

"Leave the old man alone!" Reb Nachman called out in a commanding tone. The soldiers let go of their victim. But seeing the intruder was a thin, pale, young Jew, they turned their attention on him.

"So, you would like to have a taste of this beating?" one of the soldiers called out contemptuously. He took off his belt and approached Reb Nachman. Rabbi Nachman shot a piercing glance at the soldier who remained standing with his arm paralyzed in the air. The two other soldiers tried to help their friend, but they, too, were quickly made helpless by the sharp look of Reb Nachman. Reb Nachman ordered them to put the old man on his bed and ask his forgiveness. "Now, get out of here at once and don't let your foot enter any Jewish home if you value your lives," he warned the soldiers.

Terrified and in deadly silence, the soldiers ran out. Arriving at their barracks, they told their friends about the terrible experience with the holy young Jew who had magical powers. The story spread throughout the entire French Army camp until it reached Napoleon. Napoleon had the soldiers brought to him. He questioned them and then decided to meet this unusual Rabbi, who might be able to foretell what the future had in store for him.

"That is the man," Reb Nachman heard a familiar-looking soldier say.

As Napoleon approached Reb Nachman, the rabbi rose and greeted him with great respect, saying, "Good evening, your Majesty. Blessed are you in your coming."

Amazed, Napoleon asked, "How do you know who I am?"

"Our Torah enlightens the eyes of those who follow its teachings," Reb Nachman replied. As they talked, Napoleon realized that he was conversing with a distinguished spiritual personality, who also had a deep understanding of worldly problems and events.

"Do you think I should continue my military expedition through the countries of the Middle East to reach India, or should we return to France?" he asked Reb Nachman.

Reb Nachman pondered the matter for a while then said, "The Creator has blessed you with exceptional qualities which you should use for the benefit of mankind. The way to achieve this is not through wars and bloodshed. Do not allow your military victories to mislead you. They will not bring peace to the world, and without peace you have nothing. Return home and help to create in your own country an exemplary order of justice and righteousness."

Napoleon shook his head and said, "Such a mission is not for me. I would rather live a short life full of triumph and power than a long life without them."

"Everyone has freedom of choice in the way he wishes to live," said Rabbi Nachman respectfully.

Napoleon invited Reb Nachman to accompany him as his adviser, despite the fact that he hadn't followed Reb Nachman's advice.

But Reb Nachman demurred the honor, saying, "My only wish is to serve the Alm-ghty with all my heart and with all my soul."

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PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodtko

Why does our Parsha tell us we should be "holy"?

Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

Q. Because of my chatter, I bring birds that chatter. Who am I?

A. The Metzora

THIS WEEK IN JEWISH HISTORY By: Avi Hirsch



Rebbe Menachem Mendel of Vitebsk was one of the great disciples of the Maggid of Mezritch. He was born to his father, Rebbe Moshe, who was a disciple of the Ba'al Shem Tov. He was orphaned at an early age and grew up in the home of the Rav the Maggid of Mezritch. The Maggid even took him with him when he traveled to the Ba'al Shem Tov. When the Rav the Maggid passed away and as per his will, Rebbe Menachem Mendel became the leader of the chasidim in White Russia and Lithuania.

In 5537 (1777), Rebbe Menachem Mendel made aliyah together with 300 of his chasidim. This was a very significant number of people to make aliyah as a group in that era. He first settled in Peki'in, then moved to Tzfat and finally to Tiberias, where his congregation settled.

Rebbe Menachem Mendel conducted himself and his court in a royal manner on an external level. Rebbe Yaakov Yosef of Polna'ah said that Rebbe Menachem Mendel conceals his deep lowliness specifically in what could be misinterpreted as grandeur. Rebbe Menachem Mendel would sign his letters with the subscript, "the truly lowly". Despite his youth, the disciples of the Ba'al Shem Tov admired him, and Rebbe Pinchas of Kuritz even called him "the king of Israel." Rebbe Menachem Mendel died on the first of Iyar, 5548 (1788) and was buried in the ancient cemetery of Tiberias, in the section of the students of the Ba'al Shem Tov. His student, Rebbe Elazar Zusman, collected his Torah teachings into the book, "Pri Ha'aretz."

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh



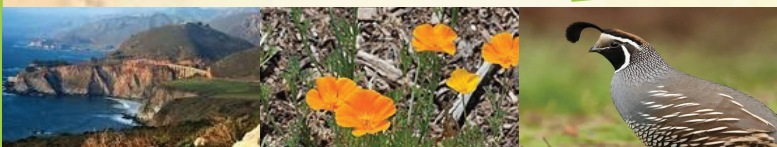
Parshas Acharei Mos. Perek 16. Pasuk 2.

"דבר אל אהרן אחיך". Aharon is referred to here as Moshe's brother. This is the only time Aharon is referred to as Moshe's brother. Why? The answer is that this parsha is after Aharon's two sons died at the hands of heaven. One of the reasons they died was as punishment to Aharon for his involvement with the golden calf. The gemara (makos 23a) states that once a person received his punishment, he should be considered your brother (אחיך) once again. Therefore, only here is Aharon called Moshe's brother because he received his punishment. (שיח הפרשה)

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Calif



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Ask Dr. Hirsch WEEK 18

Weekly Q&A with Dr. Shari Hirsch,
Pediatrician and Lactation Specialist at Lev Pediatric Care

groups.

ANSWER: A "B"

The Shul of Pomona Heights, 60 Halley drive (Mickey Schlisser)
Anshei Palisades, 11 Palisades Court, Pomona (Shalom Yoblonsky)
Ohv Yaakov Shlomo, 43 Tamarack Lane, Pomona (Yakov Rosenthal)
Kehal Avreichim Pomona, 3 Chestnut Drive, Pomona (Avi Hirsch)
9 Ladentown Road, Pomona (Berry Nash)
15 Woodfield Rd, Pomona (Doni Stern)
34 N Ridge Rd, Pomona (Shaya Setton)
Beis Mdrash Torah u Tfilah, 1 Klingher court (Nochum Wilner)
Shaarei Tefillah, New Hempstead
56 mayer Dr Montebello (Shmuel Gancz)
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84 Hsia Road, Montebello (Yanky Reichman)
Kehilas Shaar Hashamayim of 71 East Willow Tree Rd (Moshe Brachfeld)



RIBE
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